Michael J. Groff

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Objective

Goal-oriented Solutions Architect with a strong foundation in AWS Cloud technologies, and a proven track record in deploying, managing, and optimizing cloud-based solutions. Adept at problem-solving and proficient in both Windows and Linux environments, I bring a combination of technical acumen and effective communication skills. Committed to excellence, I thrive in both autonomous and team settings, readily adapting to new challenges and technologies to drive project success.

Work Experience

SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT| VIVSOFT TECHNOLGIES | WFH | SEPT 2023 – PRESENT

- Spearheaded cloud architecture solutions for critical Government projects, focusing on secure, scalable, and resilient systems design.
- Directed the strategic integration of cloud services to bolster operational capabilities, emphasizing secure data exchange and enhanced service accessibility for defense platforms.
- Led the design and implementation of cloud migration strategies, ensuring seamless transition and system optimization for mission-critical applications.
- Innovated deployment methodologies, including Blue/Green deployments, to optimize service continuity and agility in a high-stakes, secure computing environment.
- Collaborated closely with cross-functional teams to ensure alignment with stringent DoD security and operational standards, contributing to significant advancements in cloud infrastructure utilization and efficiency.
- Developed and promoted a compelling and innovative vision and value proposition, enabling customer executives to understand the financial

AWS SR. SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT| INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS | WFH | JAN 2022 – SEPT 2023

- Lead and facilitated customer discussions on migration and modernization strategies, ensuring a clear understanding of the benefits and challenges involved in moving to the AWS cloud.
- Collaborated with IT operations teams, both internally and on the customer side, to identify and develop repeatable patterns and architectures for efficient cloud migration.
- Developed, articulated, and promoted a compelling and innovative vision and value proposition, enabling customer executives to understand the financial benefits and transformational value of migrating to AWS.
- Analyzed and identified opportunities for platform improvements, influencing future iterations of the AWS platform and enhancing the Innovative Managed Cloud Services Offering.
- Worked as an integral part of a cross-functional team to identify, develop, and close deals based on solution engineering efforts, ensuring successful outcomes for all parties involved.
- Promoted AWS adoption through customer education on the value proposition of AWS, including various migration strategies, tools, and services to facilitate seamless transitions to the cloud.
- Captured and share best-practice knowledge among the AWS solutions architect community, fostering a culture of continuous learning and improvement.
- Addressed and resolved complex core business migration and modernizastion concerns related to the AWS platform through in-depth discussions, strategic presentations, recommendations, and hands-on demonstrations within the AWS environment
- Collaborated with AWS service teams to provide customer feedback, driving enhancements and new feature development to better meet customer needs.
- Stayed up-to-date with the latest AWS offerings, industry trends, and emerging technologies to ensure customers receive the most relevant and effective solutions.
- Developed and deliver technical presentations, whitepapers, and architectural diagrams to assist customers in understanding the intricacies of AWS services and design principles.
- Established and maintain strong working relationships with customers, acting as a trusted advisor and assisting in the creation of comprehensive cloud strategies.

AWS CLOUD ARCHITECT| INNOVATIVE SOLUTIONS | WFH | MAY 2021 – JAN 2022

- Design and implement AWS cloud infrastructure solutions for scalability, reliability, and high availability.

- Migrate on-premises applications and data to the AWS cloud using migration tools and best practices.
- Configure and manage AWS services such as EC2, S3, RDS, VPC, SSM, and IAM to support application deployment and maintenance.
- Implement cost-optimization strategies to reduce AWS service costs and improve resource utilization
- Monitor and maintain the security of cloud infrastructure using AWS security services, including Security Groups, NACLs, and AWS WAF.
- Automate infrastructure deployment and management using Infrastructure as Code (IAC) tools like AWS CloudFormation and Terraform.
- Set up and manage continuous integration and continuous deployment (CI/CD) pipelines using AWS CodePipeline, CodeBuild, and CodeDeploy.
- Troubleshoot and resolve cloud-related issues, working closely with application and development teams.
- Develop and implement disaster recovery and backup strategies using AWS services such as AWS Backup and AWS Elastic Disaster Recovery.
- Monitor cloud infrastructure performance and usage using AWS monitoring tools like Amazon CloudWatch and AWS X-Ray
- Collaborate with stakeholders to gather and refine requirements, ensuring alignment with organizational objectives.
- Maintain up-to-date knowledge of AWS best practices, new features, and emerging technologies to recommend improvements and enhancements to existing cloud infrastructure.

CLOUD MIGRATION ARCHITECT | ACCENTURE FEDERAL SERVICES (M9 SOLUTIONS) | SAN ANTONIO, TX | DECEMBER 2019 – MAY 2021

- Designed architecture of environments in Azure and AWS clouds using IaaS, Paas and SaaS services from both Cloud Service Providers.
- Architecture of environments included network setup of VPC/VNet, Subnets,and Load Balancers as well as application destination setup of Virtual Machines/EC2 or Application level SaaS/PaaS services (RDS, Azure SQL, Elastic Beanstalk, App Service Environment).
- Designed and constructed reusable plans to implement migrations from on-premise to customer's requested Cloud Service Provider.
- Collaborated with other project teams and senior leadership to ensure client requirements and expectations are met
- Followed Agile Methodology on migration project ensuring customer expectations and requirements are met in a timely manner.
- Reviewed customer on-premise application data to determine cloud migration candidates.
- Created cost comparison analysis between Azure and AWS for desired infrastructure.

***** Obtained an Active Security Clearance while at Accenture – Active Secret Clearance *****

CLOUD SUPPORT ENGINEER | AMAZON WEB SERVICES | DALLAS, TX | MAY 2019 – DECEMBER 2019

- Supported customers with use of AWS Services with a direct focus on Windows EC2, VPC, Auto-Scaling Groups, Directory Services, SSM, VMImport, CloudEndure, WorkSpaces, WorkDocs, WorkMail, ECS, ELB, EBS, S3, RDS, AWS Backup and more.
- Customer support included assisting with implementation of customer applications on the AWS platform, troubleshooting technical problems, migrating Windows Systems/Applications from on-premises to AWS Cloud and educating customers to better utilize AWS Services. Assisted customer with on-premises/AWS Cloud DR and HA implementations.
- As a Windows centric role, assisted customers with common Windows Roles and Features: Active Directory Domain Services, Active Directory Certificate Services MSSQL, Exchange, Terminal Server, Web Server IIS, DNS Server, etc.
- Worked directly with AWS Service and Documentation Teams to evaluate and implement global changes to update services and documentation in order to better customer experience.
- Worked with AWS CLI, AWS API and AWS Powershell to automate tasks for customer.
- Communicated with customers through phone, chat and email support and utilized screen-sharing applications to better troubleshoot customer problems and educate them on service utilization.

SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT/ENGINEER | UNIQUE DIGITAL INC | SAN ANTONIO, TX | APRIL 2017 – MAY 2019

- Plan, architect, engineer and implement IT solutions based on DellEMC and other partner technologies.
- Considered customers application requirements as well as customer's 3, 5, and 7 year goals and expectations when designing solutions

- Work with various vendors and customers across all verticals to understand their needs and requirements in order to develop and shape strategies that fulfill their IT needs.
- Responsible for providing technical expertise and leadership to internal sales teams.
- Assist the outside sales teams in all IT facets.
- Collaborate closely with product management in assessing business strategy and priorities, and tuning solutions to business goals.

SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATOR | RACKSPACE | SAN ANTONIO, TX | JAN 2015 – APRIL 2017

- Engage with our customers over the phone, in chat and through Rackspace's support portal
- Proactively address potentially impacting server issues for customers
- Increased technical knowledge by solving challenging problems
- Part of a team of experts who know the value of mentoring and technical growth for all members of the team
- Installed and Configured Windows Operating Systems as stand-alone, bare metal systems as well as on Hypervisors (Hyper-V and VMware esxi) as Virtual Machines
- Performed System Maintenance across all Windows platforms according to patching best practices. Installed Windows patches, updates and service packs, MSSQL cumulative updates, application updates, etc.
- Monitored system performance and proactively addressed potential technical issues.
- Performed system/file backups and restores based on Rackspace and customer policy
- Installed and Configured Windows Roles and Features based on customer needs: Active Directory Domain Services, Active Directory Certificate Services MSSQL, Exchange, Terminal Server, Web Server IIS, DNS Server, etc.

IT/NETWORK ADMINISTRATOR | R & K SPECIALIZED HOMES | SAN ANTONIO, TX | JULY 2013 – JAN 2015

R&K Specialized Homes Inc. provides services to people in San Antonio with developmental disabilities through ICF, HCS and Texas Home Living Programs.

- Installed, configured and maintained applications on multiple Windows Servers, a FreeNAS server, client computers at the main office and 28 WYSE thin clients at satellite locations in the San Antonio, San Marcos and South Austin Area.
- Supported Windows Active Directory and Windows Terminal Server for ~150 employees. Controlled access to business systems through Active Directory federated access.
- Generated and maintained employee user accounts and access for all IT systems resulting in secure, HIPPA compliant and up-to-date IT systems.
- Improved overall network stability by tracking down and resolving issues when they occurred, increasing overall up-time, as well as increasing licenses on necessary devices with company growth.
- Procured, set-up and managed Android and iOS cell phones through Verizon Wireless.
- Purchased, deployed and managed a VoIP Phone System containing phones across multiple locations through Ring Central resulting in a versatile cloud PBX.
- Wrote and implemented new processes for adding and removing employees into systems and applications that lead to a more streamlined and efficient procedure.
- Created video tutorials along with compatible PDF walkthroughs for staff, covering all necessary job tasks, producing a more available and efficient training system.
- Installed, managed and maintained real-time GPS Tracking for company vehicles through Network Fleet resulting in better management of company time, funds and property.
- Charged with the research, appraisal and purchasing of new technology equipment with company growth and as equipment fails or becomes out-of-date.
- Provided 24x7x365 support for 200+ employees for all business technology needs.

Education

BACHELOR OF ARTS IN THE SCHOOL OF JOURNALISM & MASS COMMUNICATION | 2013 | TEXAS STATE UNIVERSITY

- Major: Mass Communication - Electronic Media
- Minor: Music
- Awards/Scholarships: Michael J. Ballint Scholarship, Margaret Alkek Endowed Scholarship, Gnade Trust Scholarship, Knights of Columbus Scholarship, Bandera 4-H Booster Club Scholarship, St. Stanislaus Catholic Church Scholarship.